

Portfolio 2025

Sébastien Schnyder

Attentive to the spaces he occupies or traverses, Sébastien Schnyder develops a body of work that invites a reconsideration of the everyday territories we inhabit. By extracting forms and hybridizing them into composite sculptures, he constructs a world that is paradoxically familiar and strange. In his videos, the artist explores the function of spaces and their potential transformations. Laboratories, shopping centers, or botanical gardens thus become settings for a multitude of possible adventures.

Guillaume Mansart



View of the exhibition «Les sources qui cristallisent,»

Contemporary Art Center La Halle des Bouchers

© Blaise Adilon

<https://saliva.live/exhibitions/1bee3bf7>

To the Measure of Water

As every summer — since forever — he had walked miles, backpack on his shoulders, to find her trace again, scrutinizing each rock with a magnifying glass, roaming every path that might lead him to her, to her source. He knew she had passed through here, and the valley inevitably held clues of her past or underground presence, which he tried to capture with tools of his own making, alone under the blazing sun.

Was it the effect of heat and fatigue? One day, just as he was about to stop his search and resume it the next morning, he heard her. At first he thought it was the presence — invisible after all — of a lost shepherd. Then he listened more closely, and from a gleaming rock came the soft voice of the water:

*...
I am truly here for whoever knows how to listen
at times visible, at times hidden, I navigate by sight
beneath above within without
I rise and fall I melt into the landscape
I sink into the depths
I carve my bed and shape the earth I sculpt the rock that nourishes me
I slip into every crevice until I vanish, then reappear, elsewhere
I have neither beginning nor end and endlessly transform
I am in all my states
I flow from the source and continually escape whoever tries to lead me
I move across hills and hollows, from valleys to washhouses, from hand to hand
I am studied scrupulously
I am tracked I am sought
I am gathered I am channelled
I am preserved I am used
I am exploited I am spent
despite appearances, I am not transparent
I keep within me unfathomable secrets
...*

The water spoke to him gently and he felt as though rocked. If it was a hallucination, it was providence... The water was there. She was everywhere, always. But until when? Where would water come from once the glaciers were gone? How would we manage without her? Would she still whisper in the valley?

Questions streamed as dehydration loomed. He absolutely had to return to the village. After a long walk, he sat down in the shade of the trees on the square, between the washhouse and the fountain where he could go refresh himself. As he regained his senses, bluish and orange reflections shimmered from the running water, and in them he saw a new sign she was giving him in passing.

Anne-Lou Vicente



*Un court moment, 2025
wood, concrete, ceramics
300x100x45cm*



Au commencement était la fin, 2025
HD Colors 15 minutes
link: <https://vimeo.com/1113819764>
password: Fin_2025



The body of work formed by *Souvenirs* (2025) and the film *Au commencement était la fin* (2025) explores the relationships between memory, use, and the transformation of objects and environments. Positioned at the boundary between utility and futility, these works freeze hybrid objects in an indefinite time, while evoking archival systems where past, present, and potentialities overlap. These installations find their narrative extension in the film, where the same objects accompany a documentary-fiction structured in three parts: mystical, mechanical, and scientific. The film connects human gestures to environmental transformations, from the myth of the mountain to glaciology laboratories, questioning our relationship with water and the traces of time. Together, these works weave a dialogue between materiality, memory, and territory, interrogating the continuity between uses, imaginaries, and contemporary issues of perception and preservation.

Souvenirs, 2025
Steel, ceramic, plexiglass, plastic crate,
foam, brass, glass
45x62x100cm





Immémorial, 2025
Steel, ceramic, plexiglass, wood
183x45x95cm





A.B.Y.S.S.E, 2025
Steel, plaster, plexiglass, wood
183x45x95cm



Spectrum , 2025
Steel, plaster, plexiglass, wood,
magnet
15x11.5x5.5 cm

Spectrum, 2025
Steel, plaster, plexiglass, wood,
magnet
11.5x15x5.5 cm



In a moment of suspension, objects are handled by a scientist. These tools, used in medical contexts, are observed without their precise function always being defined. We closely follow the slow process of sterilization of these objects. This process questions how sanitary concerns have shaped our environment and our relationship to it. This pursuit of absolute cleanliness, initiated by the hygienist movement of the 19th century, continues to shape our cities and contemporary spaces. However, this obsession with eliminating risks can also lead to the creation of dehumanized and austere environments.

Asepsie / 2024

Vidéo HD Couleurs

8.35 min

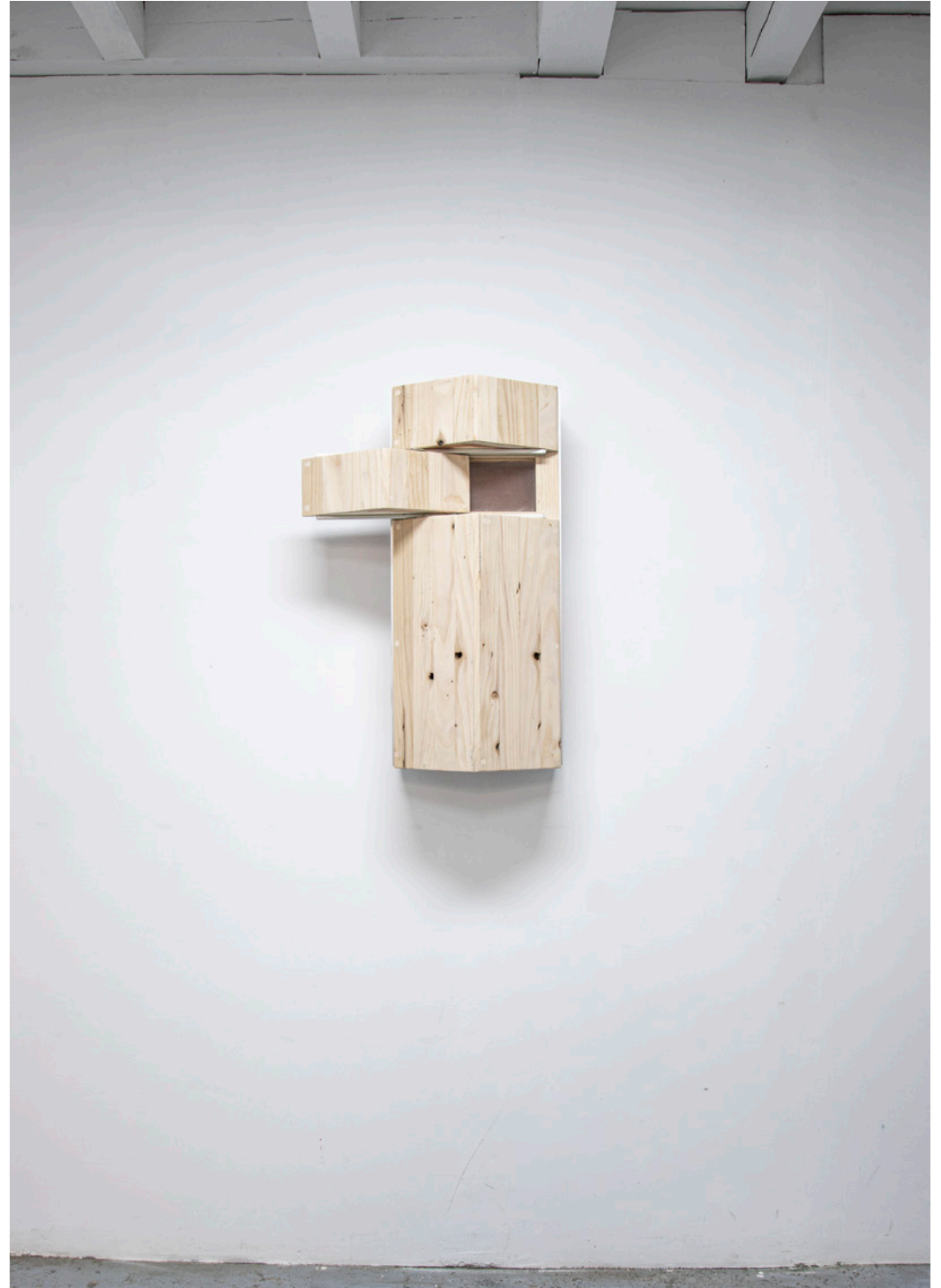
Lien: <https://vimeo.com/957813973?share=copy>

Mot de passe: Asepsie_2024

Attic / 2024

Steel, wood, ceramic, plexiglass

42x88x30 cm





Aria / 2024
steel, porcelain
15x45x30



Repos / 2024
steel, ceramics
25x75x35 cm



Lisle lumineuse is a film that focuses on the transfiguration of a public space through the installation of a fairground attraction. At the heart of the ride's assembly in a village in the Périgord, it captures the transformation orchestrated by the work of a couple of owners. «The canvases stretch, the structures rise, and little by little, the empty space fills with new life. What was once an ordinary place becomes a gathering point where the community comes together, captivated by this ephemeral spectacle.» The editing unfolds like a realm of possibilities. Here, everything seems allegorical, and the carousel that emerges could symbolize each individual's capacity to take ownership of a space and turn it into a moment of exception.

Text by Guillaume Mansart for the exhibition La Relève 7 at Château de Servière

Lisle lumineuse / 2024

Vidéo HD Colors

23 min

Link: <https://vimeo.com/954309798?share=copy>

Password: Lisle_2024



«Sweet Days of Discipline,» 2024, Contemporary Art Center – Villa Arson, credit © Jean-Christophe Lett / Villa Arson, Nice





In 1836, the architect Charles Rohault de Fleury inaugurated the large greenhouses of the Jardin des Plantes in Paris, independent of sunlight thanks to steam-heating technology. Two years later, Paul and Justin Videau founded Le Bon Marché in the 7th arrondissement, implementing commercial strategies still relevant today (varied assortment, accessible prices, and the staging of merchandise) to stimulate the desire to buy. Fascinated by this parallel development, Sébastien Schnyder presents a series of nocturnal shots set to a mysterious soundscape. The empty stores and deserted vegetable displays respond to exotic plants flourishing in enclosed glass spaces. Everything seems frozen. Vitrine thus invites reflection on the notion of progress and on our behaviors as compulsive collectors, ready to bottle life itself and treat flora as a mere consumer product.

*Vitrine, 2023
vidéo HD 7'24 minutes
Lien: <https://vimeo.com/879329299?share=cop>*



Traboules/ 2023
woos, plaster, steel
dimension variable



View of the exhibition «Resonating Ceramics 2023,» National Center for Contemporary Art – Villa Arson, Nice
© Jean-Christophe Lett / Villa Arson, Nice

A cappella, 2023
Ceramics, steel
2 sculptures : 65x86x160cm
Work created in collaboration with Béatrice Guillemann



Les corps creux 1/ 2022
resine, steel, oxyds
170x45x60 cm

Les corps creux 3/ 2022
resine, steel, oxyds
60x130x120 cm

Les corps creux 2/ 2022
resine, steel, oxyds
55x45x165 cm



View of the exhibition *Melting Pot. From the Alchemical Crucible to the Cultural Crucible* © Musée d'art et d'histoire de Neuchâtel. Photo: Nicolas Lieber

Structurel / 2021
ceramics
Dimension variable



ISO/ 2022
ceramics, steel
Dimension variable



Cabane /2021
Plaster, steel, wood
350x450x240 cm

À fleur de peau/2021
latex, wood, talc
Dimension variable



Estomac /2021
c ramique, pl tre, eau
Dimension variable



Paradis /2021
Steel, glass, magnet
80x90x170cm